Statement of Teaching Philosophy

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I have taught economics at the University of New Hampshire in several roles. As a teaching assistant I have led the undergraduate econometrics labs for Introduction to Econometrics and Advanced Econometrics, the doctoral labs for Econometrics I (ECON 926) and Microeconomics II (ECON 977), and review sessions for Principles of Microeconomics and Intermediate Microeconomics; I have been a guest lecturer in a new course on AI Prompt Engineering for Economics; and I have graded and given written feedback on analytical projects for Industrial Economics and Business Innovation, International Economics, and Innovation in the Global Economy. This fall I am the instructor of record for Principles of Microeconomics (ECON 402), a class of 75 students for which I designed the syllabus, lectures, assignments, and exams. I also learned economics in three countries and three languages before I ever taught it, and that history shapes how I run a classroom. Students arrive with very different preparation and confidence. My job is to make the core ideas of the field available to all of them without watering those ideas down. Three commitments run through my teaching. First, I distinguish the challenges that lead to learning from the ones that just get in the way. Struggling to copy code from a screen teaches nothing; struggling to see why a regression is specified one way rather than another is where the learning happens. I minimize the obstacles, so that class time goes to the reasoning. Second, I build confidence one small, achievable step at a time, with help available the moment it is needed. Third, I teach students to judge how much an answer deserves to be believed, whether it comes from a regression, a headline, or an AI.

Teaching econometrics in the lab

My clearest example of how I teach comes from the graduate econometrics lab. In the first session, students had trouble copying code from the screen while also following what the code was for. They told me, and I changed my approach the following week. I started sharing my own R scripts before class, with a comment on every line, so that class time could go to the reasoning instead of the typing. One student wrote in my evaluation:

> "She took the time to clarify each line with detailed comments, making the material much more accessible. This sharing of codes proved to be incredibly helpful, allowing us to focus on listening to the lecture and fully understanding the explanations."

Since then, in every course, I try to ask which challenges are essential to learning, and which ones just get in the way. Copying code accurately was not worth their effort. Understanding why a regression is specified one way rather than another was. I carried the same practice into the undergraduate labs for Introduction to Econometrics and Advanced Econometrics, where many students were learning R for the first time and the commented scripts mattered even more.

Helping students build confidence

Some students come into econometrics already sure that they cannot code, or that economics is not for them. I know this kind of self-doubt from the inside. I learned economics in a second language, in a new country twice, and what helped me most were the teachers who were confident I could do the work. I try to be that teacher. One of my lab students wrote that they began the semester "apprehensive about venturing into this area, as it was outside my comfort zone," and finished it having "gained confidence and a deeper appreciation for coding in R." Nothing dramatic happened in between. Each new technique came with a worked script they could run before writing their own. My office hours were working sessions where students brought broken code and we fixed it together; one wrote that whenever they hit a problem, I "was always available to meet," "patiently helping me identify and resolve the issues." Near the end of that

semester, another student emailed me because the code for their final project would not run. I went to campus to meet them, and we went through their code together, line by line, until it ran. I did not fix it for them; I helped them find their own mistakes, so the finished project was still their own work. Their evaluation described that meeting as unforgettable.

Teaching students to be honest about evidence

The third commitment builds on the first two. Once students can run an analysis and trust themselves to do it, the next skill is judging how much confidence the result deserves, and economic evidence is rarely clean. In Principles of Microeconomics, I build each week around a policy question students already have opinions about, and I bring in examples from my own research so they can see the tools being used on real questions and how far the evidence actually goes. The need for this judgment has grown now that students use generative AI. In AI Prompt Engineering for Economics, I taught students how to write prompts that produce economic analysis, and then how to check what comes back: run the code yourself, trace the number to a source, notice when an answer sounds confident but has nothing under it. When I graded projects for Industrial Economics and Business Innovation, my written feedback treated two questions separately: is the analysis correct, and is the conclusion stated with the right amount of caution? The second question surprises students. It is also the habit I most want them to keep after the course ends: to look at a policy, a price, or a headline and ask the two questions economists always ask, compared to what, and how do we know?

My teaching record

Teaching assistants at UNH are not routinely evaluated, so my most recent formal evaluation comes from the Fall 2024 graduate Econometrics I lab. Every student who responded rated both the course and me "Recommend Strongly," and all of them strongly agreed that the course increased their knowledge and skills, that it developed their problem-solving, that I created an inclusive climate for all students, and that "the instructor effectively challenged me to think and to learn." In 2025 I received UNH's Summer Teaching Assistant Fellowship, which is awarded competitively on academic performance, teaching service, and faculty recommendations. Evaluations for my current course, Principles of Microeconomics, will be available at the end of this semester.

Courses I am prepared to teach

Principles of Microeconomics and Macroeconomics, Intermediate Microeconomics, Introductory and Intermediate Econometrics (in R or Stata), Environmental and Natural Resource Economics, Public Economics and Public Finance, Cost-Benefit Analysis and Non-Market Valuation, and Data Analytics for Economics and Business. I would also welcome the chance to develop a course on using and validating AI tools in economic analysis, building on the prompt-engineering course I helped teach at UNH. Finally, because I completed a two-course field in International Economics, I would also be comfortable teaching undergraduate courses in that area.